

Project Design Document

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Project Concept

1 Player Control

You control a *A Tiny Software Bug named Nibble* in this *retro desktop platformer set inside a 1990s operating system, WindowPane 95.* game

where *the arrow keys move and jump, and the action key “corrupts” a nearby window,* makes the player *freeze that window into a solid platform or drag it to bridge a gap.*

2 Basic Gameplay

During the game, *Nibble scuttles across window title-bars, popups and the taskbar, visiting unique websites to grow stronger,* appear *while the Sentinel (a patrolling antivirus character) hunts him across the desktop.*

and the goal of the game is to *reach the Program Folder to clear the level and drop into the next one, and, once powered-up enough, Nibble can even delete the Sentinel guarding the way.*

3 Sound & Effects

There will be sound effects *for jumping, corrupting a window, visiting a new website and defeating the Sentinel retro 8-bit blips and system “error” chimes,* and particle effects *of pixel-static glitch bursts when a window corrupts and when the Sentinel is deleted.*

[optional] There will also be *a low CRT hum with a rising alarm tone as the Sentinel closes in. screen-shake and scanline flicker when the Sentinel’s scan-beam sweeps.*

4 Gameplay

As the game progresses, *each level (a new folder of the system) adds faster Sentinels, more firewalls* making it *harder to survive, pushing Nibble to visit more sites and grow before reaching the*

Mechanics

and trickier layouts,

Program Folder.

[optional] There will also be

power growth by unique websites where each new site Nibble crosses raises his size/power tier (1-bit → kilobyte → megabyte), unlocking higher jumps and stronger attacks.

tiered combat with enough power Nibble can ram and delete the Sentinel; while under-powered, contact deletes him instead.

5

User Interface

The

HUD

will

show Nibble's power meter, unique-sites counter and a "threat" indicator,

whenever

the Sentinel locks onto his position or a scan-sweep is incoming.

At the start of the game, the title

screen shows a fake WindowPane 95 boot-up with a "Start" button, and a short "Intrusion detected" prompt introduces the Sentinel and the escape,

will appear

and the game will end when

Nibble reaches the Program Folder (level clear → advance) or is deleted by the Sentinel, a scan-sweep or a fall (lose).

6

Other Features

Diegetic UI-as-level: every platform is a real desktop object windows, popups, taskbar, icons. The Sentinel is a recurring antivirus character.

Level progression: reach the Program Folder to unlock the next system area; a "Full System Scan" could serve as a late boss.

Project Timeline

Milestone	Description	Due
#1	- Core movement prototype : Nibble moves, jumps, and corrupts one window into a solid platform.	09/15
#2	- Level greybox : one desktop screen with windows/popups/taskbar as platforms and the Program Folder as the level exit.	09/29
#3	- The Sentinel enemy with chase AI, plus win/lose (reach Program Folder / deleted on contact).	10/06
#4	- Unique-website collectibles that raise power tiers, plus tiered combat to defeat the Sentinel.	10/20
#5	- Second level + difficulty ramp, HUD (power + sites counter), title screen, sound + particle FX, and polish.	11/1
Backlog	- More Sentinel variants, additional system-folder levels, a "Full System Scan" boss, and a run timer / high-score.	mm/dd

Project Sketch

